Centient

Train AI, cent by cent.

GROWTH RESEARCH · DEMAND SIDE

Campaign design partners

Which AI startups and teams to approach to fund Centient's first campaigns and become its first campaign customers, with a scored shortlist, a first cohort and an outreach plan.



Facts about other companies are from public reporting; verify each and find a real contact before outreach.

RESEARCHED	NETWORK	CANDIDATES	FIRST COHORT
7 October 2026	Stellar testnet	15 scored	5 partners

SUMMARY

AI startups to fund the first campaigns

Which AI startups and teams to approach so they fund Centient's first campaigns and become its first campaign customers. On testnet, Centient can fund those campaigns itself.

15
candidates scored
plus two for later, when Centient supports audio

5
first partners
led by Filipino-language AI

8,100
answers in the first cohort
about 4–5 days of Season 1 supply

0.20
USDC per answer at mainnet
with today's default reward and fee

Both sides need the same thing now
Testers need real, meaningful tasks every day; Centient needs named customers and case studies. A design-partner programme solves both.

A data grant costs no real money
Campaign balances on testnet are test USDC. The partner gets a human preference dataset for free; Centient gets real tasks, feedback, a case study and a letter of intent.

Start with Filipino-language AI
That's where global models are weakest (best FilBench score 72.23%; best Southeast Asian model 61.07%), where Centient's crowd is strongest, and where the platform's question bank already holds Taglish banking conversations.

Watch the competition
GIG Rewards already pays Filipinos load for rating AI responses, and Sapien runs gamified labelling. Centient's answer: per-answer dollars on a public ledger, and a quality report on every campaign.

The data grant, step by step

Partner sends pairs
Up to 1,000 prompt and response pairs, free of personal data

›

Centient funds it
A testnet campaign paid in test USDC: no real cost beyond tester incentives

›

Contributors judge
Three judgments a pair, with reasons; quality checks, spam, repetition and bias guards

›

Dataset delivered
JSON, CSV or text with train, validation and test splits, plus a quality report

›

Partner gives back
A feedback call, a case study, a letter of intent

›

Paid mainnet pilot
Prepaid USDC campaign at production scale

	A. DATA GRANT (CENTIENT FUNDS)	B. PAID PILOT (THE PARTNER FUNDS)
When	Now, on testnet	At mainnet
Contributors are paid by	Centient, in test USDC from the campaign balance	The partner, in USDC, prepaid into the campaign
Partner gives	Pairs free of personal data, a feedback call, permission to be named, a letter of intent	Prepaid USDC
Partner gets	Choices, reasons and timestamps; per-pair agreement; pool accuracy; aggregate demographics only	The same, at production scale
Centient gets	Real tasks for testers, a named first customer, product feedback	Revenue

1 · SCORING

Fifteen candidates, five criteria

Fit: text preference data in Filipino, Taglish or English that suits the task. Need: building or evaluating models now. Access: a warm path exists. Speed: can say yes in weeks. Value: name, credibility, ecosystem story or a channel.

CANDIDATE	FIT	NEED	ACCESS	SPEED	VALUE	TOTAL OF 25
TIER A · FILIPINO-LANGUAGE AI						
Proto First cohort	5	4	3	4	5	21
FilBench researchers First cohort	4	4	4	5	4	21
GradeChum First cohort	4	4	4	4	4	20
Stellar AI builders First cohort	3	2	5	5	4	19
Kollab (Senti AI) First cohort	5	3	3	3	4	18
DOST-ASTI First cohort	4	4	3	2	5	18
Thinking Machines (Temus)	4	3	3	2	4	16
TIER B · REGIONAL AND MULTILINGUAL BUILDERS						
AI Singapore (SEA-LION)	4	4	2	2	5	17
Hugging Face DIBT	3	3	3	4	4	17
Cohere Labs (Aya)	3	3	2	3	5	16
Sarvam AI	2	3	1	2	3	11
TIER C · OPEN AND CRYPTO-NATIVE LABS						
Sentient	3	3	2	3	4	15
Nous Research	3	3	2	3	4	15
Prime Intellect	3	3	2	2	4	14
Arena (LMArena)	2	2	1	1	5	11

Score 1 to 5. Scores are judgment calls from public information, meant to order outreach, not to rank the companies.

1 · SCORING

Where to start

The same scores folded into two questions: how valuable is the data to them, and how easy is the deal to land?



DOST-ASTI and Kollab sit left of the “start here” box but join the first cohort: DOST-ASTI pairs with the FilBench researchers on a public-good evaluation, and Kollab is the channel to Tagalog and Bisaya enterprise customer experience. Sanas and Philippine enterprise CX teams wait for audio tasks and case studies.

2 · THE CANDIDATES

Who they are and why they need Centient

Proto (proto.cx) — Tier A

WHO THEY ARE

AI customer-experience platform for emerging markets. Tagalog voice AI launched May 2025, funded with Canada's Scale AI cluster (not the US company) and the Gates Foundation. Deployed with the DTI, 30+ government agencies, eTap kiosks, Manila Express and GoodTech chat banking.

WHY THEY NEED CENTIENT

Its assistants answer Filipinos in Tagalog and Taglish about money and government services. “Which reply is clearer, more correct, more polite?” is exactly Centient's task.

FilBench researchers — Tier A

WHO THEY ARE

Miranda, Aco, Manuel, Cruz and Imperial (EMNLP 2025). A Filipino benchmark across cultural knowledge, classical NLP, reading comprehension and generation, with a Hugging Face leaderboard.

WHY THEY NEED CENTIENT

Generation is the weak spot, and generation is best judged by people. A human preference set for Filipino would be new.

GradeChum — Tier A

WHO THEY ARE

AI grading of handwritten and digital assessments. ₱15 million seed, DOST-TAPI backed, at GITEX AI Asia 2026.

WHY THEY NEED CENTIENT

Feedback must be clear and fair. “Which feedback helps the student more?” suits an education expert track.

Stellar-ecosystem AI builders — Tier A

WHO THEY ARE

For example StroopyAI, a Stellar assistant awarded $21.4K in SCF #20, and builders of x402 agent payments on Stellar.

WHY THEY NEED CENTIENT

Small budgets but a fast yes. “Which answer about Stellar is right?” also teaches testers Stellar, and makes an SCF story.

Kollab (Senti AI) — Tier A

WHO THEY ARE

Senti AI, Filipino NLP with Tagalog and Bisaya datasets and bank, telco and government clients, was acquired by Kollab in September 2025.

WHY THEY NEED CENTIENT

Generative CX in Philippine languages needs evaluation at scale; as a services firm, Kollab could resell it to clients.

DOST-ASTI (iTanong) — Tier A

WHO THEY ARE

Government Filipino chatbot and models for Filipino, Taglish and other Philippine languages, published on Hugging Face.

WHY THEY NEED CENTIENT

A partner rather than a customer: a public-good evaluation, credibility, and DOST grant programmes.

AI Singapore (SEA-LION) — Tier B

WHO THEY ARE

Southeast Asian models; Project SEALD with Google Research collects data in nine languages including Filipino; SEA-HELM used native speakers.

WHY THEY NEED CENTIENT

SEA-LION trails on Filipino (61.07% on FilBench); native-speaker judgments are an input it already values.

Sentient · Nous Research — Tier C

WHO THEY ARE

Sentient: $85M seed (2024); Foundation launched 19 Feb 2026; Dobby models improve from community feedback. Nous: $50M Series A (Paradigm, 2025); open Hermes models; Psyche on Solana.

WHY THEY NEED CENTIENT

Open, community-minded and comfortable with USDC. Note the Sentient name similarity: a scam risk to manage, or a partnership to make of it.

Also scored: Thinking Machines (now Temus; a channel to enterprise), Hugging Face Data is Better Together (a community sprint), Cohere Labs (open science), Prime Intellect (human preference as an evaluation environment), Arena (a long shot for verified Filipino votes), Sarvam AI (phase 2, Indic). Later, with audio: Sanas.

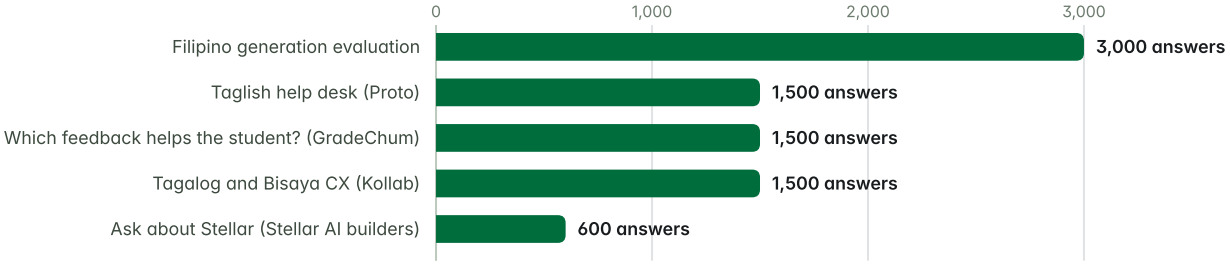
3 · THE FIRST COHORT

Five campaigns to start with

#	PARTNER	FIRST CAMPAIGN	SIZE	CONTRIBUTORS
1	**Proto**	**Taglish help desk:** a banking or government-service message, two candidate replies, "Which reply would you trust, and why?"	500 × 3	Everyone; Taglish badge track
2	**FilBench + DOST-ASTI**	**Filipino generation evaluation:** two open models answer Filipino prompts; published as an open dataset and a paper	1,000 × 3	Everyone; Taglish week's community quest
3	**GradeChum**	**Which feedback helps the student?** A student answer with two AI-written feedback variants	300 × 5	Education expert track
4	**Stellar AI builders**	**Ask about Stellar:** a Stellar question with two assistant answers	200 × 3	Everyone; learn Stellar too
5	**Kollab (Senti AI)**	**Tagalog and Bisaya customer experience:** replies judged for tone and accuracy	500 × 3	Cebuano track

Answers per first-cohort campaign

Pairs × judgments; 8,100 answers in total



At Season 1's target of 1,800 answers a day, the cohort is four to five days of supply, so the evergreen platform pool still carries most days. Use partner campaigns for themed weeks and daily drops: they're the work testers care most about.

Next wave, closer to mainnet: Sentient and Nous Research (English plus a Filipino slice, paid in USDC), AI Singapore (Filipino evaluation for SEA-LION), Hugging Face (a Filipino or Cebuano annotation sprint).

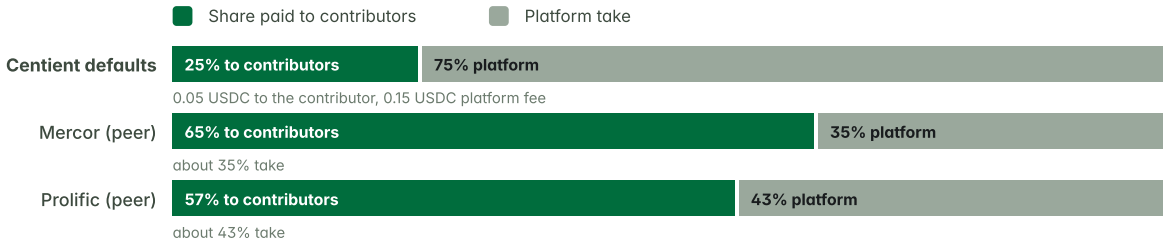
4 · PRICING

A question to settle before quoting a pilot

With today's defaults the customer pays 0.05 USDC reward + 0.15 USDC platform fee = 0.20 USDC an answer. A 1,000-pair campaign with three judgments costs 600 USDC, far below the $1–$10 per human preference datapoint the pitch deck cites.

Share of each customer dollar that reaches contributors

Centient's current defaults against the peers named in the pitch deck



Peer take rates from the pitch deck (issue #334). The pitch leans on fair pay as an ethics wedge; one option is pricing by quality tier: single judgment, consensus, expert.

5 · OUTREACH

From one-pager to letters of intent

WEEK 1
Prepare
One-pager, a live demo from the bank-ph question bank, verified contacts

Done when: One-pager approved

WEEKS 2–3
Reach out
First messages to 15 organisations, warm paths first

Done when: 15 sent

WEEKS 3–5
Discover
Calls; each partner sends 20 pairs, answered on testnet within 48 h

Done when: 5 calls, 3 agreed

WEEKS 6–9
Load
Content checked, campaigns loaded, Season 0 runs the first one

Done when: 2–3 loaded

SEASON 1
Run
Partner campaigns drive themed weeks and daily drops

Done when: Datasets delivered

SEASON 1 END
Convert
Case studies, quality reports, letters of intent

Done when: 2 LOIs for paid pilots

Warm paths

- **DOST-TAPI:** backs GradeChum and the GITEX AI Asia cohort.
- **DOST-ASTI:** the iTanong and Filipino model team.
- **Stellar:** the Instawards Philippines chapter lead, SDF contacts, SCF 7.0 referrals.
- **Hugging Face community:** the FilBench leaderboard, Data is Better Together.
- **Universities:** Philippine NLP groups, also the campus-chapter audience.

What to build for partners

- **Quality report export:** agreement distribution, pool accuracy, blocked-answer rate, aggregate demographics.
- **Content checklist at upload:** no personal data, rights to show the content, a content-warning flag.
- **Partner preview:** a read-only link to sample results before export.

5 · OUTREACH

The first message

Personalise the third paragraph for each partner, using “why they need Centient”.

SUBJECT · Free Filipino human-preference data for [product]

Hi [name],

I build Centient, a platform where people in the Philippines compare two AI responses, pick the better one and write a short reason. Each answer is paid on Stellar, and every payment is public.

We're choosing five teams for free first campaigns. You send up to 1,000 prompt and response pairs, and you get back three judgments per pair with written reasons, agreement scores and a quality report, in about two weeks.

[Product] answers people in Taglish, which is where models are weakest: the best model scores 72% on FilBench. Could I show you 20 of your own pairs answered by our contributors this week?

Carl Macabales, Centient (centient.work)

The one-pager

1. **Offer:** a free preference dataset in Filipino, Taglish or English from verified contributors in the Philippines.
2. **Task:** one prompt, two responses, one choice, one reason, with a real example.
3. **Quality:** hidden checks on 10% of tasks, agreement scores, spam, repetition and bias guards, accuracy-gated tiers.
4. **Transparency:** every contributor payment is a public Stellar transaction.
5. **Deliverables:** JSON or CSV with splits, plus a quality report.
6. **Ask:** feedback, a case study, a decision on a paid pilot.
7. **Testnet note:** contributors earn test USDC now; mainnet comes in 2027.

Competitors to watch

WHO	WHAT	CENTIENT'S ANSWER
YGG 3.0 · GIG Rewards	Load for AI quests, including rating AI responses; AI Alerts job board	Dollars per answer on a public ledger; list on AI Alerts for reach
Sapien	Gamified, points-based labelling; $5M raised	Real USDC, no token, a quality report on every campaign

Who funds the incentive budget

- Stellar Community Fund Build and Integration awards, via SCF 7.0 referrals.
- Instawards follow-on support from the Philippines chapter.
- Sponsors in kind: telcos for load, anchors or exchanges for prizes.
- Design partners: a paid pilot can carry a contributor bonus pool.

VERIFICATION AND SOURCES

Check before outreach

No contact names are invented in this brief. Verify each fact and find a real contact first.

- All funding amounts and valuations come from news and database summaries.
- Proto's partner list and May 2025 Tagalog launch come from Proto's own news pages, reached through search summaries.
- Kollab's acquisition of Senti AI (September 2025) and Temus's of Thinking Machines (2026): confirm current team structure and contacts.
- Sources disagreed on whether Senti AI raised a round in 2025 or was only acquired; the acquisition is the better-sourced fact.
- GITEX AI Asia 2026: only three of the seven DOST-TAPI startups were named in the sources found.
- StroopyAI: check the project is still active.

1. Proto, Tagalog voice AI: https://www.proto.cx/resource/mabuhay-proto-voice-ai-assistants-now-speak-tagalog
2. Proto, DTI deploys AICX: https://proto.cx/news/philippines-dti-deploys-protos-aicx-chatbot
3. Miranda et al., FilBench: https://arxiv.org/pdf/2508.03523
4. Newsbytes.PH, Pinoy AI startups at GITEX: https://newsbytes.ph/2026/03/18/7-pinoy-ai-startups-to-showcase-solutions-at-sg-event/
5. Nucamp, AI startups to watch in the Philippines: https://www.nucamp.co/blog/coding-bootcamp-philippines-phl-philippiness-top-10-startups-that-tech-professionals-should-watch-out-for-in-2025
6. Stellar Community Fund, StroopyAI: https://communityfund.stellar.org/project/stroopyai
7. Blockchain.news, SCF 7.0: https://blockchain.news/news/stellar-scf-7-grant-system-ai-screening-referrals
8. Stellar, x402 on Stellar: https://stellar.org/blog/foundation-news/x402-on-stellar
9. Malaya, Kollab acquires Senti AI: https://malaya.com.ph/weekly-features/infotech/kollab-acquires-sentiai
10. BitPinas, DOST local chatbot: https://bitpinas.com/ai/dost-local-chatgpt/
11. Manila Bulletin, Temus and Thinking Machines: https://mb.com.ph/2026/08/07/temus-backs-filipina-founded-thinking-machines-to-scale-enterprise-ai-across-southeast-asia
12. AI Singapore, Project SEALD: https://aisingapore.org/aiproducts/southeast-asian-languages-in-one-network-data-seald
13. SEA-HELM: https://arxiv.org/pdf/2502.14301
14. Hugging Face, FineWeb-C: https://huggingface.co/datasets/data-is-better-together/fineweb-c/commit/90c2ab847f2ccfb61b4d8b9c60fd7d379b68c828
15. Cohere Labs, Aya Dataset: https://arxiv.org/pdf/2402.06619
16. Inc42, Sarvam AI: https://inc42.com/buzz/sarvam-ai-in-talks-to-raise-250-mn-at-1-5-bn-valuation-report/
17. The Block, Sentient Foundation: https://www.theblock.co/amp/post/390484/sentient-foundation-launches-as-global-nonprofit-to-ensure-agi-remains-open-source-and-aligned-with-humanity
18. The Block, Nous Research Series A: https://www.theblock.co/amp/post/352000/paradigm-leads-50-million-usd-round-decentralized-ai-project-nous-research
19. Intel Capital, Prime Intellect: https://intelcapital.com/prime-intellect-raises-130m-series-a-to-build-the-open-superintelligence-stack
20. The Next Web, LMArena: https://thenextweb.com/news/lmarena-raises-150m-in-series-a-round
21. Signalbase, Sanas Series B: https://www.trysignalbase.com/news/funding/sanas-secures-65m-series-b-funding-to-empower-global-voices-with-real-time-accent-translation
22. BitPinas, GIG Rewards: https://bitpinas.com/business/gig-rewards-launch/
23. The Block, Sapien raises $5M: https://www.theblock.co/amp/post/287560/sapien-raises-5-million-for-data-labeling-with-ai-applications